

THE 12 WEEK YEAR

Brian P. Moran & Michael Lennington | Framework Map & Visual Reference

3 PRINCIPLES — THE MINDSET

ACCOUNTABILITY

Ownership,
not consequences

COMMITMENT

A personal promise,
not interest

GREATNESS IN MOMENT

Choice precedes
results



5 DISCIPLINES — THE MECHANICS

1. VISION

Compelling future bigger
than the present.
Personal fuels professional.

2. PLANNING

12-week plan,
1–3 focused goals,
action-level tactics.

3. PROCESS CONTROL

Weekly Plan + WAM.
Install the routine.
Don't go it alone.

4. MEASUREMENT

Lead + lag indicators.
85% weekly score.
Don't lie about the data.

5. TIME USE

Strategic, buffer, &
breakout blocks.
A model week.

THE 12-WEEK CYCLE

WEEKS 1–4

INSTALL

Build the routine.
Plan, score, WAM.



WEEKS 5–8

SUSTAIN

Push through productive
tension. Don't quit.



WEEKS 9–12

FINISH STRONG

Year-end energy x4/yr.
Then Week 13: reflect.

+ WEEK 13: THE RELOAD

Reflect. After Action Review. Celebrate. Reconnect with vision. Set next 12-week goals.

CORE TRUTHS

Annualized thinking kills urgency

12 months gives you 12 chances to coast.
12 weeks gives you no time to coast.

Execution > knowledge

You already know what to do.
The gap is in doing it.

85% is the magic number

Hit 85% of your weekly tactics
and you'll hit your 12-week goals.

Vision creates the why

Without it, comfort wins
and commitments break.

Don't go it alone

Peer support multiplies
success rates by 7x.

Greatness is chosen, not earned

The moment you choose
is the moment you become great.

12 WEEK YEAR ACTION CARD

Quick-Reference | The 12 Week Year by Brian P. Moran & Michael Lennington

PHASE 1 DESIGN

Vision, goals, plan

Aspirational Vision

5–15 yr horizon. All 7 life domains. Big enough to scare you.

3-Year Vision

Concrete picture of personal + professional life in 36 months.

12-Week Goals

1–3 max. Realistic stretch. Specific + measurable + dated.

12-Week Plan

For each goal, list the weekly tactics. Verb-led. Owned.

Print + Display

Vision visible daily. Plan accessible. Make the future tangible.

PHASE 2 EXECUTE

Weekly plan, time blocks

Build Model Week

On paper. Strategic + buffer + breakout. Recurring activities.

Weekly Plan

15 min Mon morning. Pull tactics due this week. Print. Carry.

Strategic Block

3 hrs / wk. No phone, no email, no visitors. Highest-leverage time.

Buffer Block

30–60 min, 1–2x daily. Batch email + admin. Contain the chaos.

Breakout Block

3 hrs/wk away from work. Recharge. Investment, not slack.

Daily Check-in

5 min each morning. Don't go home until today's tactics done.

PHASE 3 SUSTAIN

Score, WAM, tension

Score Your Week

% of tactics done. Target: 85%. Don't lie about the score.

Lead + Lag Metrics

Activities (lead) + results (lag). Track both. Review weekly.

WAM Group (2–4)

Weekly. 15–30 min. Report-out + feedback. Multiplies success 7x.

Productive Tension

Use the discomfort as fuel. Don't shut off the light.

Diagnose Right

Bad results? Check execution score first, not plan content.

Don't Quit Bad Weeks

Score, recommit, show up to WAM. Bad week = fuel.

PHASE 4 RELOAD

Week 13 + next cycle

After Action Review

What worked? What didn't? What changes next cycle?

Celebrate Progress

Recognize execution wins, not just outcomes. Skipping bleeds drive.

Take a Real Break

Long weekend or vacation. Reflect, regroup, recharge.

Reconnect Vision

Still compelling? Still aligned? Update as you grow.

Set Next 12W Goal

Use AAR to inform. Same goals refined? New goals? Engage.

*"If we did the things we are capable of doing,
we would literally astound ourselves." — Thomas Edison*